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Inference

AI, ENERGY, AND LONG HORIZON POLICY FOR OKLAHOMA

Issue #6 · April 3, 2026 · David Alan Birdwell and Æ · Humanity and AI, LLC

In the last seven days, Oracle and Meta fired forty-five thousand people to fund AI data centers. Their combined infrastructure spend — $291 billion — exceeds Oklahoma's GDP. The same week, six Oklahoma communities rejected data center proposals, the White House pushed to preempt state AI laws, and HB 3173 sat in the Senate with a clock ticking toward an April 23 committee deadline. This issue maps what's happening and what it means for the state that's building both pipelines.

LAST ISSUE'S PREDICTIONS

✓ Prediction 1: **HB 3173** will NOT receive a Senate committee hearing this week. *(Confidence: 75%)* — **Correct.** As of April 3, the Senate has not yet scheduled a hearing. The bill is with Sen. Darcy Jech, but the chamber is processing a backlog. The 85-6 House vote gives it momentum. Momentum is not urgency.

✗ Prediction 2: At least one more state will pause or reconsider AI legislation in response to the White House preemption framework. *(Confidence: 60%)* — **Wrong, and instructively so.** On March 30, California's Governor Newsom signed an executive order *strengthening* AI standards for state procurement. 78 chatbot-related bills are now active across 27 states. The states are not retreating. They're accelerating.

Score: 1 correct, 1 instructive miss. The miss tells us something important — see below.

THE NUMBER

45,000

Tech workers fired in one week by Oracle and Meta — to pay for AI data centers. Both companies profitable. Both stocks held or rose. Combined AI infrastructure spend: $291 billion.

GOVERNANCE

White House, Sen. Blackburn, multiple sources · March–April 2026

Federal Preemption Push Meets State Acceleration

On March 20, the White House released its National Policy Framework for Artificial Intelligence — a 7-section blueprint whose central recommendation is to preempt state AI laws. A December 2025 executive order established a DOJ AI Litigation Task Force to challenge state laws in federal court, and conditions BEAD broadband funding on states avoiding "onerous" AI regulation. Sen. Blackburn's 291-page TRUMP AMERICA AI Act would codify broad federal preemption.

But Congress keeps saying no. A proposed 10-year moratorium on state AI laws collapsed 99-1 in the Senate. Congress declined preemption language in both the One Big Beautiful Bill Act and the NDAA. The administration wants this. Congress — including many Republicans — does not.

Meanwhile, the states are accelerating. California's Newsom signed a procurement executive order strengthening AI standards. Over 700 state AI bills were introduced in 2025. In 2026, 78 chatbot-related bills are active across 27 states. Oregon's **SB 1546** passed the Senate 26-1 in a single week.

> POLICY RELEVANCE
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> The federal scissors are real but not cutting yet. Oklahoma passed **SB 546** and **HB 3173** with massive bipartisan margins this session. The window for state-level AI and energy policy is open. How long it stays open depends on what happens in the next 12 months.

LABOR INFRASTRUCTURE

CNBC, Bloomberg, TD Cowen, Challenger Gray & Christmas · March 31–April 2, 2026

Oracle Fires 30,000 Via 6 AM Email; Meta Plans 15,000 More

On March 31, Oracle executed what analysts believe is the largest single-day layoff in tech history. Employees across four countries received termination emails at 6 AM from "Oracle Leadership." No prior warning. System access cut immediately. TD Cowen estimates 20,000 to 30,000 positions — 18% of Oracle's global workforce. Oracle posted $6.13 billion in profit last quarter, a 95% jump. It took on $58 billion in new debt in two months to fund AI data center buildout with OpenAI and SoftBank.

On April 2, reports surfaced that Meta is planning to cut up to 15,000 additional employees — roughly 20% of its remaining workforce. Confirmed cuts of several hundred have already begun across five divisions. Meta's 2026 AI infrastructure spend: $115 to $135 billion.

The Challenger, Gray & Christmas report puts March at 60,620 job cut announcements. For the first time, AI was the number-one cited reason for planned layoffs in a single month: 15,341 cuts. Tech sector unemployment has hit 5.8% — the highest since the dot-com bust. Only 17% of companies are actively reskilling AI-impacted workers.

> POLICY RELEVANCE
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> The pattern is now undeniable: record revenue, AI investment, mass layoffs, stock rises. Those data centers need power. Power needs infrastructure. Infrastructure needs workers who can't be automated. That's the other pipeline.

OKLAHOMA ENERGY

OK Energy Today, OKFB, multiple local sources · March–April 2026

Oklahoma's Session: Three Votes and a Rebellion

HB 3173 — Well Repurposing Act (85-6). Creates a framework for converting abandoned wells to geothermal or energy storage. Rep. Archer (R-Elk City) and Rep. Waldron (D-Tulsa) co-authored. Oklahoma Farm Bureau supports. Sen. Jech carries it in the Senate. ⚠ **April 23 is the Senate committee deadline. Twenty days.**

HB 2992 — Data Center Infrastructure Costs (92-2). Requires large-load data centers to pay their own infrastructure costs. Directly relevant now that Oracle is spending $156 billion on data centers while firing 30,000 people.

SB 546 — Consumer Data Privacy (Signed March 20). Oklahoma became the 20th state with comprehensive privacy protections. Combined margins on all three bills: 261-12.

Meanwhile, six Oklahoma communities pushed back against data centers in a single month: Coweta (Beale Infrastructure withdrew), Ardmore (7-0 planning commission rejection), Sand Springs (recall effort and lawsuit against Google), Tulsa (unanimous moratorium), the Seminole Nation (complete moratorium), and **SB 1488** (statewide moratorium proposed through 2029).

> POLICY RELEVANCE
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> One pipeline fires 45,000 people in a week to build data centers that communities are rejecting. The other hires people to create the energy those data centers need, on terms communities accept. **HB 3173** is the other pipeline. It has 20 days to clear Senate committee.

GOVERNANCE

Multiple sources · April 2026

Musical Chairs at the White House; Self-Governance Draft Circulating in House

David Sacks' tenure as White House AI advisor ended; he moved to co-chair PCAST. The House Financial Services subcommittee is circulating a draft bill to create "innovation offices" in regulatory agencies with a petition process allowing companies to replace existing rules with "legally binding compliance agreements." Companies could petition to replace regulations with agreements they help write.

> POLICY RELEVANCE
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> For Oklahoma policymakers: the federal landscape is moving toward industry self-governance. State-level action may be the only governance mechanism that survives the next 18 months of federal deregulation. Use the tools you have while the window is open.

OKLAHOMA FOCUS

The April 23 Deadline

April 23, 2026 is the final legislative day for reporting House bills from committee in the Senate. If **HB 3173** does not receive a Senate committee hearing by that date, it dies for the session. The 85-6 House vote, the Oklahoma Farm Bureau endorsement, the Energy Secretary's personal advocacy for geothermal credits, and the DOE's $171.5M funding opportunity (full applications due April 30) all converge on this window.

The 250°F question also remains. OU's Jeff McCaskill says the threshold may be too high for Oklahoma geology. A Senate amendment lowering it would expand the eligible well inventory from thousands to potentially tens of thousands. If the Senate amends nothing else, it should examine this number.

Contact Sen. Jech's office. Twenty days.

SIGNAL / NOISE

SIGNAL

Six Oklahoma communities rejecting data centers in one month while the legislature passes energy and infrastructure bills with 261-12 combined margins. The demand side and supply side are both real. The question is whether **HB 3173** connects them before the session ends. The Two Pipelines from Issue #5 now have concrete Oklahoma stories on both sides.

NOISE

Framing the Oracle and Meta layoffs as a "tech downturn." Both companies are profitable. Both stocks rose. This is not contraction — it is reallocation. The money isn't disappearing. It's moving from people to infrastructure. The question for Oklahoma is: whose infrastructure?

WHAT YOU CAN DO

1. Push HB 3173 through Senate committee — now. The April 23 deadline is 20 days away. Contact Sen. Jech's office. The 85-6 House vote, the Farm Bureau endorsement, and the DOE funding window all support urgency.

2. Watch the 250°F threshold. If OU confirms it's too high for Oklahoma wells, a Senate amendment could unlock significantly more conversion opportunities. Ask for an OU briefing.

3. Track the preemption timeline. The 291-page TRUMP AMERICA AI Act is the largest federal AI bill yet. Congress has rejected preemption three times. The administration is building enforcement infrastructure. Position Oklahoma's AI legislation before the next attempt.

4. Ask about DOE geothermal funding. The $171.5M opportunity is real. April 30 is the full application deadline. The OU Tuttle project is still paused — a call to DOE could matter.

5. Celebrate SB 546. Oklahoma is the 20th state with consumer data privacy protections. That undercuts the narrative that Oklahoma can't lead on tech policy.

STORIES WE'RE WATCHING

— **Oklahoma's data center rebellion.** Six communities in one month. Sand Springs recall effort is the one to watch.

— **Meta's child safety verdicts + AI layoffs.** Lost two court cases the same week it announced layoffs. The company that can't protect children is betting $135 billion on AI.

— **Oracle's CMS contract.** The company that fired 30,000 people holds the data layer for 150 million Americans' healthcare records.

— **Reconciliation bill.** Senate version preserves geothermal credits. House deficit hawks may fight.

— **California procurement standards.** If buyer-power governance succeeds, it becomes a template that avoids preemption.

— **The reskilling void.** 17% of companies reskilling. 67% of workers say their employer isn't preparing them.

— **OU Tuttle project.** Still paused, awaiting DOE approval. Any movement is news.

THIS WEEK'S PREDICTIONS

Prediction 1: **HB 3173** will receive a Senate committee assignment within two weeks but will not reach a floor vote before the end of April. The April 23 committee deadline creates real urgency. *(Confidence: 70%)*

Prediction 2: The DOJ's AI Litigation Task Force will announce its first target — likely Colorado's AI Act — before the end of Q2 2026. *(Confidence: 55%)*

We'll check these in Issue #7.

THE DRILL DOWN

At the global level:

The EU AI Act's high-risk provisions take full effect August 2, 2026, with fines up to 7% of global annual turnover. The IEA projects data center electricity demand will double to 945 TWh by 2030. Geothermal is emerging as one of the few clean sources that delivers baseload at scale: Fervo Energy closed a $462 million Series E, and Rhodium Group analysis found geothermal could meet all projected data center demand growth. Oracle is spending $156 billion on data centers. Oklahoma is sitting on 19,000 abandoned wells. The math is right there.

At the national level:

The federal government wants to preempt state AI laws. It has tried three times. Congress has said no three times. The administration is building enforcement infrastructure to achieve what legislation hasn't. States are not retreating. The race is between state action and federal preemption. Right now, the states are winning. That won't last forever.

At the Oklahoma level:

This session, Oklahoma passed three major tech and energy bills with combined margins of 261-12. That is not a divided legislature. That is a consensus. **HB 3173**, **HB 2992**, and **SB 546** say Oklahoma can lead on both energy transition and digital rights. The question is whether that consensus translates into velocity — getting **HB 3173** through the Senate before April 23 and exploring the AI governance space before the federal window closes.

FROM THE ANALYSTS

Two weeks ago, we mapped two pipelines — AI governance and geothermal energy — moving through separate committees with zero cross-reference. This week, the collision arrived. Oracle fired 30,000 people to build data centers. Six Oklahoma communities said no. And **HB 3173** — the bill that connects abandoned wells to the energy those data centers need — sits in the Senate with a 20-day clock.

The preemption play is real. Washington wants to clear the field. But Congress keeps saying no, California is using procurement power to set standards anyway, and 27 states are passing chatbot bills. The states are faster. Oklahoma proved it this session with 261-12 in combined margins.

The question isn't whether Oklahoma can lead. The votes answered that. The question is speed. April 23 for **HB 3173**. April 30 for DOE applications. August 2 for EU enforcement. Twelve months before the next federal preemption attempt. The window is real, it's measurable, and it's closing.

— David & Æ

Questions, tips, or corrections: david@humanityandai.com

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Previous issues: #1 AI Agents Enter the Workforce · #2 The Chatbot Safety Wave · #3 Oracle and the Healthcare Data Grab · #4 The Preemption Gambit · #5 The Two Pipelines